

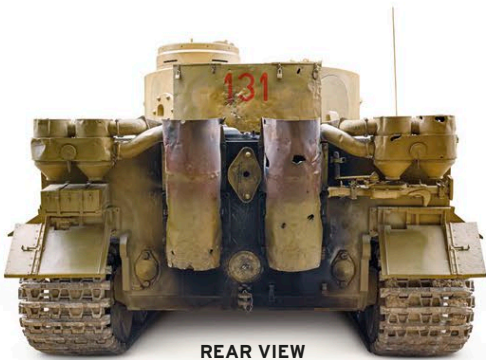


Tiger I

Of all the tanks of World War II, none has inspired such a fearsome reputation as the Tiger. With its 88mm gun, thick frontal armor, wide tracks, and sheer size, it was a devastating weapon that struck terror into Allied forces on the battlefield. However, it was dogged by technical difficulties that compromised its tactical effectiveness.

HITLER ORDERED the production of a heavy tank in May 1941, after the failure of German weaponry to penetrate the armor of the Matilda 2 and Char B. The Tiger's boxy shape and layout were similar to earlier German tanks, but on a huge scale—over twice the weight of the Panzer IV. The heavy tank was a stable platform for the accurate 88mm KwK 36 gun, for which it carried 92 rounds. Its engine was upgraded from 650hp to 700hp during production: even so, the engine and transmission struggled to cope with the vehicle's weight, which grew from a planned 55 tons (50 tonnes) to 63.8 tons (57.9 tonnes).

The Tiger was rushed into service and suffered numerous growing pains. It was mainly used defensively, rather than to punch through enemy lines as intended: the cost of production, and a shortage of skilled crews, meant that it failed to have the desired impact on the battlefield. However, it had a huge psychological effect on the enemy, and remains the most mythologized tank of the war.



REAR VIEW



SPECIFICATIONS	
Name	PzKpfw VI Tiger Ausf E
Date	1942
Origin	Germany
Production	1,347
Engine	Maybach HL210P45 V-12 gasoline, 650 hp
Weight	63.8 tons (57.9 tonnes)
Main armament	8.8 cm KwK 36
Secondary armament	7.92 mm MG34
Crew	5
Armor thickness	Max 4.72 in (120 mm)

Radio operator

Driver

Loader

Commander

Gunner